

YASHI GAKHAR

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EDUCATION

Shoolini University, Himachal Pradesh, India

Bachelor's in Food Technology

August 2021 – June 2025

CGPA: 8.6

Relevant Courses: Computer Programming(c++), Basic Statistics, Organisational Behaviour, Mathematics, SPRINT, Graphic Designing, Fun with IOT, Aptitude Development

University Of Naples Federico II, Naples, Italy

September 2024 – February 2025

Exchange Semester Program - Food Innovation and Product Design

PROJECTS

Functional Fruit-Based Beverage for Elderly Bone Health

- Formulated a plant-based functional beverage using banana, pomegranate, basil seeds, and vitamin D3 to support bone health in the elderly
- Applied high-pressure homogenization and natural emulsifiers to enhance nutrient stability, emulsion quality, and mouthfeel
- Optimized pH and viscosity parameters while conducting sensory profiling and nutrient retention tests to ensure consumer acceptability and efficacy
- Developed the product in alignment with EFSA-compliant claims for improved calcium absorption and bone density, addressing vitamin D deficiency in aging populations

Ballisimo – Superfood Energy Ball

- Developed a clean-label Mediterranean energy ball using nutrient-dense superfoods, targeting the functional snack market with plant-based innovation
- Performed sensory evaluation (n=60), water activity testing, shelf-life estimation, and texture analysis, achieving 76% overall acceptability
- Benchmarked nutritional profiles and consumer appeal against 5 market competitors, informing product positioning and packaging strategy

Dehydrated Vegetable Powders – Nutritional & Functional Analysis

- Analyzed the impact of hot air oven drying and blanching on bioactive compounds in carrot and beetroot using spectrophotometric techniques
- Quantified antioxidant activity (DPPH, FRAP), total phenolic content, and flavonoids to evaluate nutritional retention post-dehydration
- Assessed functional properties such as rehydration ratio and water solubility index (WSI) to determine suitability for functional food applications

WORK EXPERIENCE

Food Analyst Intern | Food Corporation of India, New Delhi, India

Jan 2024

- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to optimize supply chain operations across three regional zones under the Public Distribution System (PDS)
- Analyzed procurement and warehouse data to aid decision-making for managing over 100 metric tons of food grain inventory
- Assisted in maintaining quality control and documentation in alignment with national food safety and FCI compliance standards
- Participated in field visits with FCI officials, gaining first-hand exposure to public food distribution logistics and government policy implementation

Quality Assurance Intern | Mother Dairy

Jan 2023 - Feb 2023

- Conducted over 25 chemical and microbial tests to identify adulterants and assess the quality of milk and dairy products
- Assisted in ensuring compliance with FSSAI and internal standards through routine quality checks and QA reporting
- Maintained detailed lab records and supported internal audits, contributing to consistent product safety and hygiene protocols
- Gained hands-on experience in food quality control systems, enhancing precision, documentation accuracy, and process consistency

EXTRACURRICULARS

- Led awareness sessions and coordinated outreach efforts with Red Taboos Club, helping deliver menstrual health education and hygiene kits to over 100 rural schoolgirls while localizing content for greater impact
- Organized college-level sports events such as the Inter university Sports Meet and Annual Marathon promoting inclusivity by encouraging student participation, contributing to a more active and fitness-driven campus culture through the Sports Club
- Volunteered with the Indian Association of Muscular Dystrophy (IAMD), assisting in awareness sessions and patient support at the Dystrophy Centre, while strengthening empathy and community engagement
- Participated in multiple 5K and 10K marathons conducted by Shoolini University, enhancing physical endurance, mental discipline, and goal-oriented consistency

ACHIEVEMENT:

- Secured Gold Medal in Women's Singles Table Tennis at the Inter-University Level, showcasing competitive excellence and athletic discipline

SKILLS

Languages: English (Proficient) | Hindi (Native)

IT: Lab Analysis | SQL | Python | C++

Certifications: Food & Beverage Management (Università Bocconi) | Dairy Production & Management (Penn State University) | Industrial Bioprocess Development (Technical University of Denmark) | Introduction to Data Analysis Using Microsoft Excel (Coursera Project Network) | Global Food Systems Transformation (University of Copenhagen)

New Delhi, India

